

Q+A

# Unstoppable Him

Age is just a number for **KABIR BEDI**, 79, who has had a spate of recent OTT releases and has many projects in the pipeline

**Q. Tell us about some of your recent roles.**
I've been busier recently than I have been in a long, long time. I released an Italian film in Italy, called Questione di Stoffa (A Question of Fabric), last November. It is the story of the rivalry between an Indian and Italian family of tailors. Currently, I also have four new shows on various OTT platforms, including Berlin on Zee5, Life Hill Gayi on JioHotstar, Tanaav 2 on SonyLiv and the latest is Aachari Baa with Neena Gupta on JioHotstar.

**Q. If you hadn't turned to acting, what would you have become?**
I had wanted to be an architect, because I was fascinated with buildings. But because I had to work my way through college due to family circumstances, I couldn't. So, while studying history at St Stephen's College, I worked on the side at All India Radio and Doordarshan. That's what launched my career, and sent me off to Bombay. It all happened because I managed to scoop an interview with The Beatles while working at AIR.

**Q. Your parents were both spiritual people. Are you too?**
My parents went from being freedom fighters to becoming very important spiritual figures. My mother became the highest ordained Buddhist monk in the world in the Tibetan tradition, and my father became a philosopher who had a major impact in Italy. In fact, I myself was ordained as a Buddhist monk in Burma when I was about 12. I also believe in the tenets of the Sikh religion, which is part of my heritage.

**Q. What are you working on next?**
I'm now flying to Canada to shoot a film about six soldiers in the Second World War. In the summer, I'll be shooting another Italian film. Apart from that, there are two more OTT projects in discussion.

–with Neha Kirpal

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